



# CONTRACTOR OF THE YEAR ASSESSMENT GUIDE

## Evaluation Framework for the Project Contractor of the Year (PCoTY) Award 2027

*For Stage 1 assessors and Stage 2 judges.*

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### INTRODUCTION

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This is the Evaluation Framework for the Project Contractor of the Year (PCoTY) Award 2027. It is the formal guide for a rigorous, transparent, and consistent review of every nomination.

The cycle looks for contractors who move **beyond competence toward excellence**: not only fulfilling the contract, but transforming practice through novel approaches, pioneering techniques, and measurable impact others can learn from.

Customer evaluation is separate. Clients score seven operational dimensions on a **0-10 weighted scale**. You score the **nine award criteria on a 1-10 scale** (same range as the portal sliders). Do not convert one into the other.

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### YOUR JOB

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Independently score assigned nominations on **nine criteria (1-10)** with a justification on each. Finish by the deadline.

**You do:** confirm conflict of interest, read the packet (and the customer evaluation if it is available to you), score, comment, submit.

**You do not:** run eligibility or completeness checks (intake and admins gate that), coach nominees, or share scores with nominees.

**Conflict of interest:** if you have a conflict, stop and contact the organisers for reassignment. Do not score that nomination.

There is **no Nominee Coach**. Questions go to organisers or admin.

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## SCORING SCALE

Sliders on the Assessor Dashboard and Calibration Exam are **minimum 1, maximum 10, step 1**.

| Score | Meaning                             |
|-------|-------------------------------------|
| 1     | Not demonstrated / missing evidence |
| 2     | Poor                                |
| 3-4   | Fair                                |
| 5-6   | Good                                |
| 7-8   | Very good                           |
| 9-10  | Excellent                           |

Nine criteria, 10 maximum each. **90 is the highest** a nomination can receive from one assessor or judge.

At least **two independent reviews** per nomination (target three when capacity allows). If two assessors differ by **more than 4 points** on a criterion, the Project Manager moderates. Discuss evidence, not ego.

1 is not a moral judgement. It means the packet did not show it. 5-6 is solid professional work. 9-10 is exceptional and evidenced. Do not save 10 for "someone else". If the evidence is there, give it.

## THE NINE CRITERIA

Score each one. A comment is required.

| # | Criterion                                  | Look for                                                                                                    | Ask                                                        |
|---|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Project Success (outcomes)                 | Delivery vs baseline; benefits; handover; measurable impact and transformation                              | Did they deliver? What lasting impact?                     |
| 2 | Agility and Adaptability                   | Change control; fit to the contracting model (including T&M cash and visibility)                            | How did they handle change without chaos?                  |
| 3 | Commercial Model (liquidity)               | Price realism; milestones; advances and retentions; liquidity on both sides; supply-chain payment           | Fair cash flow for both parties? Was the price real?       |
| 4 | Legal Soundness                            | Law and jurisdiction; warranty and liability; privity; fit to the collaboration model                       | Complete, enforceable, suited to the model?                |
| 5 | Interface and Governance                   | Customer-contractor boundary; escalation; decision rights                                                   | Clear boundary and working governance?                     |
| 6 | Risk Management (cross-corporate)          | Cross-party financial, ops, IP, cyber, regulatory, reputational, geopolitical risks and mitigations         | Risks identified and mitigated across the interface?       |
| 7 | People Development                         | Investment as % of profit: 0 / 0-5 / 5%+; training and certification evidence                               | Real investment with delivery impact?                      |
| 8 | Team and Business Acumen                   | Leadership; candour; initiative; customer vs profit balance; code of conduct; anti-corruption; transparency | Integrity and leadership under pressure?                   |
| 9 | <b>Innovation and Industry Advancement</b> | Novelty; industry contribution; knowledge sharing; case-study worth                                         | Would we publish this? Winners typically <b>8-10</b> here. |

## Notes on selected criteria

**Agility (2), T&M contracts.** Consider billing frequency vs contractor cash-flow needs, rate transparency, client cost visibility, and whether change control stays compatible with the project objectives.

**Commercial model (3).** Price realism and whether money reached the people doing the work. A lowball bid is not a discount; it is a wild-card invoice you have not received yet. Overpricing is the same problem later. Fragile supply-chain payment is a commercial failure, not only a procurement footnote.

**People development (7).** Categories are 0%, 0-5%, or 5%+ of net income or profit invested in staff development (technical, organisational, or commercial). Higher investment usually correlates with better delivery and a more capable customer relationship. A 0% with no other evidence of development is a red flag, not a neutral score.

**Team and business acumen (8).** Candour (raising what would turn green to amber) and initiative (bringing a better way, not only executing the ticket) sit beside integrity and leadership.

**Innovation (9).** This is the filter that distinguishes winners from competent performers. High scores on delivery or legal soundness are not enough.

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## CRITERION 9 IN DETAIL

Use these descriptors when scoring Innovation and Industry Advancement:

| Score | Descriptor                                                                                                                     |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Not demonstrated / missing evidence                                                                                            |
| 2     | Poor. Standard approach, no innovation, no industry contribution                                                               |
| 3-4   | Fair. Some novel elements, minor improvements, limited knowledge sharing                                                       |
| 5-6   | Good. Solid innovation, some industry relevance, basic knowledge sharing                                                       |
| 7-8   | Very good. Significant innovation, industry-relevant, active knowledge sharing, replicable practices                           |
| 9-10  | Excellent. Groundbreaking approach, advances the profession, extensive knowledge sharing, highly replicable, case-study worthy |

Winners typically score **8-10** on this criterion. A 10 is only for work that is groundbreaking or that advances the profession.

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## COMMENT TIPS

For each criterion: why this score, strengths, gaps, and pointers to evidence (section or artifact). Be objective, consistent, and constructive.

**Credo check for winners:** excellence, impact, industry contribution, innovation, legacy. Not merely competent delivery.

**Red flags:** missing evidence, no measurable impact, generic approach, no knowledge sharing, integrity concerns, 0% people development.

**Green flags:** clear transformation, real innovation, active sharing, strong cross-party risk and integrity, 5%+ people development, case-study worthy.

Silence in the packet is not neutral. If you find nothing for a criterion, record that you found nothing and score accordingly.

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## STAGE 1: ASSESSORS

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1. Confirm no conflict of interest.
2. Read the nomination packet (narrative, artifacts, and customer evaluation if shown).
3. Score criteria 1-9 (1-10) with a comment on each.
4. Submit by the deadline.

You may be asked to join **moderation** if scores diverge. Do not share scores with nominees. Refer them to the organisers.

Intake has already checked eligibility and completeness. You are scoring quality, not chasing missing files. If a required artifact is genuinely absent, that is evidence for the related criterion, not a reason to reopen intake.

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## STAGE 2: JUDGING PANEL

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Shortlisted nominees present **20 minutes** plus **15 minutes of questions**. They arrive **already carrying a category label** (assigned at intake for the award title). The panel does not re-bucket them. Scoring is the same for every shortlisted project.

Judges:

- Attend the presentation and Q&A.
- **Rescore all nine criteria independently (1-10)**, with strong attention to Criterion 9.
- Use the customer evaluation and the Q&A as input, not as a substitute for their own scores.
- Join outlier moderation (difference of more than 4 points) and final deliberation.
- Name **four awards** from the Stage 2 field: **one overall** Project Contractor of the Year, plus **one** Small, **one** Medium, and **one** Large category award. Dual title is allowed. Empty category awards stay empty if the field is thin.

Consensus or a moderated average determines those awards. In a stalemate, Oliver F. Lehmann has the deciding vote.

Presentations may be recorded and published, subject to consent.

Once assessor and customer numbers are in, the panel still applies a qualitative lens: does this nomination move past standard expectations?

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## EXEMPLARY ANCHORS

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| Standard performance (competence)        | Exemplary performance (winner)                                      |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Competence: did the job very well        | Excellence: did something uniquely valuable                         |
| Compliance: had good processes           | Impact: created measurable, lasting change                          |
| Success: the customer was happy          | Industry contribution: shared knowledge and advanced the profession |
| Standards: followed best practices       | Innovation: created new best practices                              |
| Project completion: finished the project | Legacy: transformed relationships and left a lasting impact         |

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## THE CASE-STUDY TEST

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The last practical question for the panel:

### **Would we want to publish this as a case study?**

If the project is competent but does not offer lessons others can use, it is unlikely to win, regardless of how high the base delivery scores are.